

Regression Testing

Verification that changes did not introduce unintended effects in existing functionality.

What is Regression Testing?

Regression Testing verifies whether a change introduced side effects in behaviors that already worked. A fix, new feature, refactoring, configuration change or integration can affect seemingly distant areas. Regression protects existing capabilities while the product evolves.

When to execute

After fixes, features, refactoring, dependency changes, configuration, database, APIs, infrastructure or relevant releases. The intensity should follow the risk of the change.

Retest vs Regression

Retest specifically confirms that the corrected defect no longer occurs. Regression verifies whether the fix or another change affected other parts. After a coupon BUG, for example, retest the corrected coupon and perform regression on price, subtotal, promotions, cart and checkout according to impact.

How to choose the scope

Start from the functional and technical diff: what changed, dependencies, shared components, integrations, defect history, criticality, revenue, security and usage. Build an impact zone instead of automatically running the entire suite.

Practical example

Change: new shipping calculation. Possible regression: valid/invalid postal code, shipping methods, free shipping, subtotal, related coupons, cart update, checkout, orders and logistics integration. The scope comes from dependencies and risks.

Full vs selective

Full regression runs a broad suite and costs more time. Selective regression chooses tests based on impact and risk. Not every change requires the entire suite; not every small change is low risk.

Automation

Stable, repetitive, critical and frequently executed scenarios are good candidates. Monitor false positives, execution time and maintenance. Automation without strategy can create a large suite that nobody trusts.

Prioritization

A useful order: critical business flows → directly changed areas → dependencies → integrations → defect history → lower-risk scenarios. Adjust according to time and context.



Quick checklist

Did I understand the change? Map the impact? Retest fixes? Cover critical flows? Integrations? Data? Permissions? Relevant Mobile/Web? Reliable automated tests? Document uncovered risks?

QA Mindset

Regression does not mean “run everything”. It means building confidence that the change did not degrade important existing behaviors.